

Barriers/ Noise in communication

Flow of information is not always smooth. Any disruption or interference anywhere along the communication process is called noise or barrier. For eg. Loud music in background, letter lost in mail, poor internet connection, bad handwriting, too many technical jargons, etc. Barriers have been divided under three broad areas:

1. **Organization**: There are certain flaws in the way an organization works that may impede the smooth communication flow within an organization. Some of these factors are:
 - Email overload and use of excessive technical jargons: Phill Simon a business consultant says that on an average, a worker receives 100-120 emails everyday. It is likely that person may misplace, delete or not even see some crucial message. Use of too many technical jargons in communication and expect all in an organization to understand the message.
 - Loss of control over external situation: if some major changes are in pipeline due to internal/external circumstance that may impact the workers and beneficiaries then it is a duty of the Head of the organization to explain it to employees before they hear from outside sources.
 - Communication Silos: Organization works in compartments that are not exchanging information. Thus people in different roles focus only on their objectives. There is a lack of collaboration within an organization. Such attitude results in lack of fresh perspective and honest discussions. Consequently, quality of work suffers.
 - Overall lack of communication: There are constant changes in management that are not clearly communicated to workers. Lack of clarity in directions issued from the management. "Messages are sent and received whether or not company chose to communicate"
2. **Management**: Some factors disturb the flow of smooth communication due to lack of good administration. Some examples are:

- Distracting working environment such as constantly ringing telephone, being called by the senior in room over trivial matters, colleagues in habit of just barging in and out during sessions, etc.
- Vague feedback: individual fails to understand the body-language of the senior giving a feedback over a mistake that senior is angry or sarcastic. Person fails to appreciate how serious mistake was.
- Badly drafted messages with uncommon short forms and technical jargons.

3. **Individual:** Two levels of barriers can be seen at an individual level

- Psychological barriers: Poor retention, jumping to conclusion, and lack of control on angry outbursts, lacking in confidence
- Personality barriers: fear of authority, lack of incentives,

Example of Companies that could not sustain due to communication failure:

NOKIA

ENRON

Strategies to Overcome Barriers

- 1) Keep channel two way. Both partners should maintain direct interface without hindrance.
- 2) Exchange timely message because old information is worse than no information at all.
- 3) Avoid pre-mature evaluations
- 4) Keep information consistent at all levels.
- 5) Be attentive to non-verbal cues.
- 6) Demarcate **facts** from conclusions and interpretations.

Power of 7 C's

- **Clear:** State the purpose of communication clearly. Use words like query/request/reminder/apology/recommendations/ urgent information, etc.
- **Concise:** Short brief cut and dry Re-Issue of ID Card/complaint/query/reminder/
- **Correct:** All facts and figures cross-checked thoroughly
- **Complete:** All information such as time, venue, date, day, etc.
- **Coherent:** Avoid technical jargons, short forms, grammatical error, well-formed sentences
- **Courteous:** No matter what ... leave with a smile and courteous note.
- **Concrete:** Concentrate on facts.